NORTHSTAR PUBLIC SERVICES CONSORTIUM

Apex Systems

ENGINEERED FOR SCALE

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL · RESPONSE

Fictional procurement scenario | Supplier evaluation platform | October 2026

Executive summary

Apex proposes a secure, modular procurement response platform for the fictional Northstar Public Services Consortium. The scope includes supplier intake, evaluation workflow, audit history, and an executive dashboard. Our design prioritizes resilience and data protection; the investment is above the consortium's indicative budget.

Requirement understanding

Northstar seeks one controlled workspace to receive supplier responses, support consistent criterion-based review, preserve evidence and approvals, and create a defensible award record. This response is fictional and prepared only for a classroom demonstration.

Proposed solution

A containerized web application with an API gateway, event-driven document processing, and a PostgreSQL data layer. REST integrations are proposed for identity and the consortium's ERP. The ERP connector is described at a high level; interface mapping would be confirmed during discovery. The design targets 99.9% monthly availability and horizontal scale to 500 concurrent users.

Implementation plan & team

Phase	Duration	Staffing / milestone
Discovery	3 weeks	Product lead, architect; signed requirements
Build	10 weeks	6 engineers, QA; alpha and integration tests
Pilot	4 weeks	2 implementation leads; 40-user acceptance
Launch	2 weeks	Cutover, training, operational handover

Commercial proposal

Cost item	USD
Implementation	$428,000
Annual platform and support	$142,000
Three-year estimate	$854,000
Assumptions	Up to 3 integrations; taxes and data migration excluded

Security, compliance & risk controls

Apex documents SOC 2 Type II and ISO 27001 certification, AES-256 encryption at rest, TLS 1.2+ in transit, SSO with SAML, role-based access, centralized audit logs, and annual penetration testing. Data residency is offered in US regions. A named incident commander provides 24-hour notification for critical incidents. A residual risk is that the submitted proposal does not attach the current SOC 2 report or a detailed disaster-recovery test result.

Delivery risks and mitigations

The consortium should confirm integration scope, data migration responsibility, service-level measurement, and acceptance criteria before contract signature. A named joint risk log and weekly delivery checkpoint are recommended. Supplier statements in this synthetic response are illustrative and are not independently verified.

Support model & relevant experience

A 24/7 critical-incident desk provides a one-hour response target for severity 1 and four hours for severity 2. The proposal names two public-sector deployments supporting 300 and 420 users. Two customer contacts are offered after award; reference letters are not attached.

Governance & acceptance

A steering group should meet monthly; the delivery team should report weekly on milestones, risks, decisions, and open defects. Acceptance should require signed user-acceptance results, resolved critical defects, tested backup recovery, an approved operations runbook, and administrator training.

Commercial assumptions

All amounts are fictional USD estimates for comparison practice. Taxes, contract terms, and any exclusions shown in the price table must be confirmed during negotiation. No real customer, supplier, or confidential information is represented.

END OF FICTIONAL RESPONSE